



Discussion Guide: Gary Mason

Jesus and Religious Ethnic Nationalism

Reflect

- When have you seen or experienced religion or theology do harm? How has that impacted you individually? How has it impacted your community or society at large?
- Gary quotes Jonathan Swift as saying, "We have enough religion to make us hate each other, but not enough to love each other." What is it about religion that can make groups hate one another? What examples can you think of from Scripture in which faith compels someone to overcome hate and embrace love?
- Gary says, "I hold God tightly, but the church loosely." How do you understand the distinction he is making? How would making such a distinction be helpful to you and your faith?

Respond

- Gary challenges us to bring faith into the public square, where all aspects of life come together. If we were to respond to this challenge, what public issues and questions might the church come to pay greater attention to?
- Gary ends his talk with the question, "Will you throw your lot in with a temporal system or with God's eternal kingdom?" How would you describe the difference between the two in terms of their values and assumptions? How might the values and assumptions of God's eternal kingdom help heal the social divides that exist today?